

## Brynn's Letter

*Found the morning of the trek to Site C — a folded paper tucked into Loric's pack, sealed with the thistle-and-ash sigil of Shadowdale. No signature. It was not in his pack when he went to sleep. It was in it when he woke.*

### Brynn Ashford — Shadowdale's Delegate to the Dales Council

#### *Where You Know Him From*

Lean man in his early thirties. Ink-stained fingers — he writes everything down. Thistle-and-ash badge pinned at the collar of a clean leather doublet. Speaks for **Lady Ulphor** at the Dales Council in Ashabenford and is currently quartered in Shadowdale.

You met him at the briefing in Lady Ulphor's working room before you rode for the Hawthorn Chimney. After the meeting broke, he pulled **Loric** aside privately and revealed — quietly, and without Lady Ulphor's blessing — that **Orvyn Tal is a Harper**. He asked the party to bring its findings to him *before* the Harpers, with a vague offer of "incentivity." Loric made no promise.

*Whatever you find at the third site, I want a sketch and a number before Orvyn does.*

*I am not asking you to lie to him.*

*I am asking you to choose the door you knock on first.*